

AI-driven Persuasion in Cyberspace: Through the Lens of Cialdini's Six Principles

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Received on 28 October 2025; Accepted on 20 November 2025

Abstract

The speed at which technology is developing makes it practically difficult to keep up with or anticipate every scenario that could occur in the future. Large Language Models (LLMs) have become essential as learning and jobs change in parallel with this explosive expansion, particularly in light of the most recent developments in generative artificial intelligence. There are more opportunities, both good and bad, when demand rises. Good effects are tailed with tutorials whereas negative effects are discovered. Persuasion, though a skill that can be learned and practiced, also involves numerous abstracted techniques. In an era of exploding knowledge, it is impossible to keep everything hidden from everyone. We surveyed 300 individuals from various professions (including students) who use ChatGPT to learn more about their attitudes of the platform and the reliability of its results. As this study will further investigate, ChatGPT itself has the ability to convince users with non-factual material. However, this paper's main focus is on how sophisticated training models have developed to the point where they may be manipulated, sometimes inadvertently turning regular users into expert persuaders. This presents serious issues with preserving a secure online environment.

Keywords: Psychological Triggers, Social proof, ChatGPT, Social Engineering, Robert Cialdini, AI, LLM, Hallucination, GenAI, GAN, Variational Autoencoders